

The yfinance Library: Yahoo Finance Data Made Easy

The `yfinance` library provides a simple way to download market data from Yahoo Finance, one of the most popular free financial data sources. Here's how to install and use it:

```
1. # Install the library (you only need to do this once)
2. # pip install yfinance
3.
4. # Import the library
5. import yfinance as yf
6. import pandas as pd
7.
8. # Download data for Apple stock (ticker symbol: AAPL)
9. apple_data = yf.download("AAPL", start="2023-01-01", end="2023-07-01")
10.
11. # Display the first few rows of data
12. print(apple_data.head())
13.
```

This simple code downloads six months of daily price data for Apple stock and displays the first few rows. The data is returned in a pandas DataFrame—a powerful data structure we'll work with extensively.

The `yfinance` library supports:

- Individual stocks (e.g., "AAPL", "MSFT")
- Market indices (e.g., "^GSPC" for the S&P 500)
- Cryptocurrencies (e.g., "BTC-USD" for Bitcoin)
- Foreign exchange pairs (e.g., "EURUSD=X" for Euro/USD)
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For each security, you can specify the date range and interval (e.g., daily, weekly, or intraday data).

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